

Writing Memos

A memo (or memorandum, meaning “reminder”) is normally used for communicating policies, procedures, or related official business **within** an organization. It is often written from a one-to-all perspective (like mass communication), broadcasting a message to an audience, rather than a one-on-one, interpersonal communication. It may also be used to update a team on activities for a given project or to inform a specific group within a company of an event, action, or observance.

Memos can be tricky because they often communicate to multiple audiences who have different levels of knowledge about the context. **For example**, if you are communicating a new company policy, different types of employees will want to know exactly how the policy impacts them.

Common Memo Writing Situations

Memos are used in a variety of workplace communication situations, from documentation of procedures and policies to simple announcements. Below are some common types of memos:

- Policies (changes and new)
- Instructions
- Procedures
- Announcements
- Trip reports

Writing Letters

As one of the most formal documents you can send, a letter conveys a high degree of respect to its recipient. Sending a letter is your way of saying that the recipient matters. Letters are usually one- to two-page documents sent to people or organizations outside of the organization from which they are sent, whereas memos are equivalent documents for formal communications within an organization.

Common Letter Writing Situations

Though we use email for many of the occasions that we used to send letters for before the twenty-first century, letters are still sent rather than emails for several purposes:

- Cover letters to employers in job applications
- Thank-you letters and other goodwill expressions

- Letters of recommendation (a.k.a. reference letters)
- Letters of transmittal to introduce reports or proposals
- Campaign initiatives, such as for fundraising or political advocacy
- Official announcements of products, services, and promotions to customers
- Claims and other complaints sent to companies to lay down a formal paper-trail record as evidence in case matters escalate into the court system
- Formal rejection notices to job or program applicants
- Collection notices to people with overdue payments

In these cases, letters offer the advantage of formality, confidentiality (it is illegal to open someone else's mail), and a record of evidence.

There are two main types of letters: **block-style letters** and **modified-block style**. The block style used by organizations has a company letterhead at the top, whereas modified-block letters are typically written independently by individuals. Regardless of the type of letter you need to write, it can contain up to fifteen elements. While you may not use all the elements in every case or context.

BASIS FOR COMPARISON	MEMO	LETTER
Meaning	Memo refers to a short message, written in an informal tone for interoffice circulation of the information.	Letter are a type of verbal communication, that contains a compressed message, conveyed to the party external to the business.
Nature	Informal and Concise	Formal and informative
Exchanged between	Departments, units or superior-subordinate within the organization.	Two business houses or between the company and client.
Length	Short	Comparatively long
Signature	Signature is not required in a memo.	A letter is duly signed by the sender.
Communication	One to many	One to one
Content	Use of technical jargon and personal pronoun is allowed.	Simple words are used and written in third person.

How to write a memo?

- ❖ While each memo should be written to address its key points and unique needs, there are a few steps you can follow to create a clear, highly readable document.
- ❖ Like many other professional business documents, memos will include an introduction, body, and conclusion.

Header: Start with a header that indicates that the communication is a memorandum, the intended recipients, the sender, the date, and the subject.

Example:

To: All AU Employees

From: Shoukat Ali Abbasi, Human Resources Director

Date: Dec. 02, 2056

Subject: Adnan Ahmed retirement

Introduction: Write an introduction that uses a declarative sentence to announce the main topic of the memo.

Example:

I am writing this message to inform you that Adnan Ahmed will be retiring from Aror University of Art, Architecture, Design, and Heritage Sukkur, effective Dec. 02, 2056. Adnan has been a dedicated employee of the company for more than four decades.

Body:

- ✓ Include a body paragraph with discussion points that elaborate on or list the main ideas associated with the memo's topic.
- ✓ To make your memo easier to read, write in short paragraphs and break the information into smaller, more manageable chunks.
- ✓ Since the recipients will likely be scanning the memo, you should also use subheadings and bulleted lists when possible.

Example:

As the Professor of Applied Linguistics, Adnan demonstrated exceptional skills in research and bridged the gap in understanding the Global South Colonialism. He has given his all during his tenure, and we appreciate his efforts in helping the university grow by publishing in WoS journals.

We know this will be a transition for us and Aror University is in the process of recruiting his replacement, which will be difficult, given the big shoes to fill. On a celebratory note, we are planning to throw a retirement party for him, so stay tuned for further details on that.

Conclusion: Conclude your memo with any remaining information following the body paragraph. This is a summary of the memo and should clearly inform the reader of any action(s) required.

Example:

I encourage you to take some time out and stop by Adnan's office to congratulate him on this deserving accomplishment.

Closing: Close with your name, email address, and phone number in case anyone needs to contact you.

Example:

Thank you again, Jason, for your dedicated and hard work.

Best regards,

ABCD

abcd@aror.edu.pk

Attachments: Ensure any necessary attachments are included if your intended recipients will need to refer to other information, such as a graph, sidebar, image or chart, below the end of your memo.

Tips for writing effective memo:

- ❖ Always consider your audience when writing a memo
- ❖ Proofread and review before sending
- ❖ Write a subject that is straightforward and clear

How to write a basic business letter?

When sending a formal letter in a professional context, you should use business letter format. For example, you will use business letter format when writing a cover letter as a part of a job application or when writing a letter of recommendation.

Business Letter Components

Sender's Address

This is typically the first information that appears on your letter. Following Pakistan Post Office format, include your street address, city, state, and zip code in this section. If you are sending a letter as a part of your job, then it is appropriate for this address to be your business address. If you are sending this letter for your own interests (for example, if you are writing a cover letter), you should use your home address.

Date

After the sender's address, write today's date on a new line.

Block Form

Arslan M. Saeed

_____ Airport Road

Sukkur, Sindh Pakistan

February 17, 2026

Recipient's Name

Next, write the recipient's name. After listing the recipient's name, write their professional title (e.g., President, Associate Professor, Business Analyst) on a new line.

Recipient's Address

On a series of new lines, write the recipient's address using Pakistan Post Office format. This should include their street address, city, state, and ZIP code. Since this is a business letter, you should use the recipient's business address (not their home address).

Salutation

Now you will begin your letter. It is typical to start the letter with the salutation "Dear x:" (where x is the name of your letter's recipient). In general, it is polite to include the recipient's courtesy title (e.g., Dr., Ms. Mr., Mx.). If you are not sure what they use, you might do some research to find the answer or, in the case that this research is inconclusive, leave off the courtesy title altogether and just include the recipient's first and last name.

Bilal Rizvi

Summer Programs Coordinator

Center for Excellence

66020 Karachi Road

Khairpur, Pakistan

Dear Mr. Rizvi:

Body of the Letter

After the salutation, use paragraphs to convey your message. Since this letter will be read in a business context, we recommend that you use clear and straightforward language to communicate your ideas. It is conventional to include at least three paragraphs: (1) an introductory paragraph that summarizes your main points, (2) a body paragraph that gives more detail, and (3) a concluding paragraph that explains what next steps need to be taken.

“Thank you for the opportunity to interview for the assistant instructor position for the Design and Build Workshop at the Center for Excellence. I enjoyed our conversation and the chance to find out more about your summer program and its student learning outcomes.

I am excited by the Center’s commitment to making math engaging and accessible for middle schoolers through hands-on activities and interactive games, and I especially loved hearing about the way “Math Magic for Minds!” often sparks a genuine interest in the subject for students. Our conversation reinforced my core belief that fun is an essential part of the educational process, especially for young learners, and lays a foundation for future academic success.

Thank you for taking the time to speak with me about this position. I’m eager to work with the Center for Excellence and bring my creativity into the math classroom. If you need more information from me at any point, please do not hesitate to reach out.”

Closing

After the body of your letter has concluded, finish by using a closing phrase such as “Sincerely,” “Thank you,” or “Best.” After this phrase and the appropriate punctuation (usually a comma), skip four lines and then type your name. In the blank space between the closing phrase and your typed name, sign the letter. In the case where you are sending the letter electronically (for example, as a PDF attachment to an email), you can electronically sign the letter through an application such as [Adobe Acrobat Reader](#).

Warm regards,

A handwritten signature in black ink that reads "Harper M. Reyes". The script is cursive and fluid, with the first letters of each word being capitalized and slightly larger than the rest of the letters.

Harper M. Reyes

References:

<https://www.indeed.com/career-advice/career-development/memo-writing-guide>

<https://writing.wisc.edu/handbook/businessletter/>